



WHEN THEY CALL

What to say when you are asked if you are willing to participate
A plain-language script to keep beside the phone

THE ONE THING TO KNOW

Your benefits are put at risk by **refusing or neglecting to take part**. They are not put at risk by **being unable**. Not being able to work, or not being able to find work, is protected. So you do not have to argue about willingness on the phone. Say yes to taking part, and put your limits on the record separately. Both are true at once: you are willing, and you are limited.

WHEN THEY ASK: “Are you willing to participate?”

“Yes, I am willing to participate.”

Then, right away, in your own words:

“I want to be clear on the record about my situation. My condition limits what I am able to do, and it is unpredictable. I want that noted on my file.”

Willing · then limits · then noted on file

SAY THIS, NOT THAT

Instead of	Say
“I can’t participate.”	“I am willing to take part in what I am able to do. Here is what my health does not allow.”
“I don’t really have a choice.”	“Yes, I am willing.” (It costs you nothing, and it cannot be written down as reluctance.)
Answering fast because you feel put on the spot	“I want to answer that carefully. Can you send me that question in writing?”

DURING THE CALL

- You are allowed to slow it down. “Can you repeat that? I want to make sure I understand what I am agreeing to.”
- Ask what is being written down: “What will you be recording on my file from this call?” You have every right to know.
- You do not have to be alone. Put a friend or family member on speaker to listen and take notes.
- Write down the date, the time, and the name of the person you spoke with.
- Not sure the call is genuine? You can hang up and call Alberta Supports yourself at **1-877-644-9992**.

AFTER THE CALL — PUT IT IN WRITING

A phone answer can be denied later. Send a short message the same day: “On [date] I spoke with your office. I confirmed I am willing to participate. I also stated that my condition limits me in the following ways: [list them]. Please correct me in writing if your record differs.” Keep their reply. Now your version is the record.

Nobody should have to script themselves to stay safe while telling the truth about their own body. That we prepare for this call like a test says everything about the system, and nothing about you.